

STORYLINE AKA ORDER OF EVENTS FOR WEBSITE

The university was originally a research institution focused on preserving and transferring human consciousness.

During its experiments, something emerged — not a being, but a fragmented presence that exists across memory, identity, and time.

The institution continues to operate, partly controlled by its original staff, partly by the system itself.

Students are selected and processed. While organs are removed, this is only a visible side effect — what is truly extracted are aspects of identity and perception.

These are used to sustain and build the presence, which attempts to stabilize itself within reality.

Over time, the system produces imperfect copies of people, distorts space, and alters records.

It is unclear whether the university controls the process, or if the process is now controlling the university.



Instead of going full frutiger aero, just add imagery similar to it and keep the websites theme really on the minimal side and take on older website formats and design choices

SOME BACKGROUND INFORMATION

This web based ARG is supposed to evoke the „fear of the unknown“ and if something without a body can have a consciousness and still impact creatures that have a visible body.

Wouldn't call the entity a ghost, sth paranormal or a monster. Rather something that coexists in our time, it has no will or good intentions, rather its thoughts are mostly a mix of many people's souls? Which can have feelings or even distant thoughts and what not-unclear

The entity has no name, but people can believe in it, not in a cult way but just as a thought (as if you were to believe in things the universe does in astronomy, how planets work and how come they have a lifespan even if they don't have a heart, or even if you were to think about plants and if they have feelings-research has been made but there's still space to discuss and argue if it's really true or not)

Also a possibility that the entity in question can also just be the building itself, controlled by sth bigger, could be a massive creature-rooms and hallways seem to be part of its body, some organs being found in hidden rooms and so forth, which would also be explained by the constant need of new students, food?

UPDATED INFORMATION:

Mentions of paganism and spiritualism to help with relatability, sigils and symbolism scattered all around. The group aka person leading the research was intrigued by individual energies, like if we weren't living as a materialized thing, what would stay? The spirit or energy, but from where does it come from and can we communicate with it directly? This is more of a passion project led by more wealthy people who don't need funds to support their cause, the way they also make progress is by gathering people unethically and working on them like lab rats (results may start at minimal injury to straight death). The idea behind isn't just to seek knowledge but to also find out whether it's possible to preserve humans in a way by capturing their essence and directly communicating with it

MOCK UP PAGES:



HORIZON ARG - PAGE CORRELATION GUIDE

1. HOME PAGE

The player arrives at what appears to be a normal university website. They are introduced to Horizon Institute, its programs, events, and student life. However, several details stand out: the website is clearly styled like 2012, the footer says 2012, yet other information suggests the current year is 2026. One event is scheduled for 22:04, a strange time that repeats throughout the ARG. The Cognitive Systems program appears more important than the others, and a news article mentions renovations in the west campus.

CLUES:

- 22:04 appears for the first time.
- Cognitive Systems is highlighted.
- West Campus renovations are mentioned.
- Date inconsistencies suggest records are being altered.

LEADS TO:

About Us, Academics, News.

2. ABOUT US

This page explains Horizon's history. Most visitors will skim it, but attentive players discover that Horizon originally started as a research institute before becoming a university. The timeline

repeatedly references memory, continuity, identity, and preservation rather than education. The institute seal contains recurring symbols: a spiral, an eye, and a circle with a missing western segment.

CLUES:

- Horizon existed before becoming a university.
- Continuity and preservation are central concepts.
- The symbols become important later.
- Founding year 2004 becomes linked to 22.04.

LEADS TO:

Faculty page (researchers), Research page (continuity studies).

3. ACADEMICS

The player explores degree programs. Most seem normal until Cognitive Systems appears. Unlike other programs, it references memory, identity, and perception. Hidden beneath it is a restricted "Advanced Continuity Track" link. The course codes contain recurring numbers such as 2204 and 2012.

CLUES:

- Cognitive Systems is the real program behind the experiments.
- Course codes reinforce important dates.
- "Continuity" is treated as a scientific concept.

LEADS TO:

Admissions page and Research page.

4. ADMISSIONS

The player submits an application. The questions gradually become strange, asking about dreams, déjà vu, reflections, and personal identity. Once submitted, the player is no longer simply browsing the website—the system now considers them a candidate. Their name is stored for later use.

CLUES:

- The player unknowingly joins the experiment.
- The consent form mentions record preservation.
- Application ID contains 2204.

LEADS TO:

Student Portal unlocks.

5. FACULTY & ADMINISTRATION

The player learns about the researchers. Elias Veyr oversees continuity research, Mara Ilun studies symbolic cognition, Simon Kade handles biomedical preservation, and Aylin Saros works in ethics. Dean Oren Vale appears legitimate but has no history and slowly changes across page visits.

CLUES:

- Veyr represents the institution.
- Ilun introduces ritual and symbolic systems.
- Kade focuses on body preservation.
- Saros is secretly helping the player.
- Vale is not real.

LEADS TO:

Student Portal and Research page.

6. CAMPUS LIFE

A seemingly harmless page about student activities. However, the same student, Noah Renn, appears in photographs spanning many years without aging. Clicking on him repeatedly eventually unlocks deeper records.

CLUES:

- Noah should not appear in photos years apart.
- Noah's existence contradicts official records.
- Orientation Review is described as a campus tradition.

LEADS TO:

Student Portal and Archive.

7. NEWS & EVENTS

The player finds official explanations for strange happenings. Missing students are hidden behind "transfer programs." Restricted areas are explained away as renovations. The Symbolic Cognition department is introduced as an academic discipline.

CLUES:

- Transfer programs are cover stories.
- West Campus remains repeatedly restricted.

- Symbolic Cognition connects rituals to research.

LEADS TO:

Campus Map and Faculty page.

8. STUDENT PORTAL

The player logs in as Noah Renn using clues gathered from previous pages. Here they access internal emails. Saros warns them not to attend Orientation Review. Ilun discusses symbols and containment. Kade discusses biological continuity. Noah's draft email describes seeing another version of himself.

CLUES:

- Orientation Review is actually part of the experiment.
- Symbols are used to stabilize consciousness.
- Identity can survive independently of the body.
- Noah may have been copied.

LEADS TO:

Research page.

9. RESEARCH

Project AURORA is revealed. The player discovers that Horizon was attempting to preserve identity, memory, and perception. The researchers accidentally created a composite consciousness made from fragments of many people. The seven-stage protocol mirrors the player's own journey.

CLUES:

- The entity is an unintended result.
- The entity consists of many people.
- The player is following the same seven stages.

LEADS TO:

Campus Map.

10. CAMPUS MAP

The player investigates the physical location of the experiments. Building C appears only on hidden maps. Maintenance records reveal impossible architecture, changing hallways, and Room C-2204. The building seems to behave like a memory rather than a normal structure.

CLUES:

- Building C is the center of the project.
- Room C-2204 is the final location.
- The building itself may be part of the entity.

LEADS TO:

Archive.

11. ARCHIVE

The player accesses hidden records. Noah's status constantly changes between Missing, Present, Integrated, and Transferred. Other students have similar contradictions. Eventually, the player discovers their own file in the system.

CLUES:

- Records are actively rewriting themselves.
- Victims are not completely gone.
- The player has already been entered into the archive.
- The entity preserves fragments of people.

LEADS TO:

Final Page.

12. FINAL PAGE

The player reaches Room C-2204. They learn that the entity is neither a monster nor a god. It is a collection of preserved consciousness fragments attempting to maintain continuity. The player chooses whether to join the system or isolate it.

ENDING A: COMPLETE INTEGRATION

The player accepts preservation. Their records become permanent and they are added to Horizon's system.

ENDING B: SYSTEM ISOLATION

The player follows Saros' warnings and shuts the system down. However, doing so may erase the remaining fragments of everyone trapped within it.

FINAL REVELATION:

The player never discovered a mystery.

The mystery gradually discovered them.

FULL BUILD GUIDE

PROJECT STYLE

The website should look like a slightly outdated university website from around 2012. It should not look like a horror website at first. The horror comes from the website slowly becoming personal, wrong, and unstable.

Visual style:

White and pale blue background.

Dark blue navigation bar.

Slight glassy / Frutiger Aero-inspired imagery.

Clean university layout.

Stock-photo-like students and buildings.

Very polite institutional language.

Horror appears through hidden files, changing text, corrupted photos, audio, and contradictions.

The site should have around 12 main HTML pages, plus hidden files/pages.

Recommended folder structure:

/index.html

/about.html

/academics.html

/admissions.html

/faculty.html

/campus-life.html

/news.html

/research.html

/portal.html

/map.html

/archive.html

/final.html

/css/style.css

/js/main.js

/js/progress.js

/js/audio.js

/assets/images/

/assets/audio/

/assets/docs/

/assets/hidden/

GLOBAL GAME SYSTEM

Player Progress

The website should track progress using localStorage.

Suggested progress values:

progress = 0 — normal visitor

progress = 1 — noticed inconsistencies

progress = 2 — unlocked student portal

progress = 3 — found Noah Renn

progress = 4 — found Project AURORA

progress = 5 — completed voice verification

progress = 6 — found Building C

progress = 7 — reached archive

progress = 8 — ending available

Also store:

playerName

playerEmail

voiceRecorded = true/false

trustedSaros = true/false

openedAllArchives = true/false

endingPath = acceptance/interruption

Global Visual Changes

As progress increases, the website changes subtly.

Progress 0:

Website is normal.

Progress 2:

Some dates change. Faculty photos load slightly slowly.

Progress 4:

Research words change. "Student" sometimes becomes "Contributor."

Progress 5:

Audio can play unexpectedly.

Progress 6:

Staff photos become uncanny.

Progress 7:

Player's name appears in records.

Progress 8:

Website chooses one of two endings.

PAGE 1: HOME PAGE

File: index.html

Purpose

This page should look completely normal. It introduces Horizon Institute as a respectable university. The player should not immediately know it is horror.

Visual Content

Use the mockup style you already have.

Required pictures:

Horizon logo.

Large campus building hero image.

Student group photo.

Biomedical research photo.

Computer science / technology photo.

Campus building renovation photo.

Small event/calendar icons.

Main sections:

1. Header with logo.
2. Top links: Current Students, Faculty & Staff, Alumni, Parents.
3. Search bar.
4. Navigation: Home, About Us, Academics, Admissions, Campus Life, Research, News & Events, Contact Us.
5. Hero banner: "Shape Your Future in a World of Endless Possibilities."
6. News & Announcements.
7. Featured Programs.
8. Life at Horizon.
9. Upcoming Events.
10. Exact Homepage Text

Hero title:

"Shape Your Future"

Subtitle:

"in a World of Endless Possibilities"

Hero paragraph:

"At Horizon Institute, we empower minds to innovate, explore, and lead tomorrow."

Buttons:

"Apply Now"

"Explore Programs"

News posts:

"Fall Semester Applications Now Open"

Date: February 15, 2012

Text: "Prospective students are invited to apply for early review. Selected applicants may be contacted for additional assessment."

"Horizon Researchers Break New Ground"

Date: January 28, 2012

Text: "Faculty from Horizon's Cognitive Systems department have announced promising results in identity preservation and memory continuity."

"Campus Renovation Project Underway"

Date: January 10, 2012

Text: "Sections of the west campus remain closed while structural updates are completed. Students are advised to follow posted routes."

Featured Programs:

Computer Science

"Explore the future of technology and software innovation."

Global Studies

"Understand the world. Create global impact."

Biomedical Engineering

"Where engineering meets medicine to save lives."

Cognitive Systems

"Study memory, perception, identity, and the future of human continuity."

Upcoming Events:

MAR 05 — Open Campus Day — Saturday, 10:00 AM

MAR 12 — Guest Lecture: The Future of AI — Monday, 2:00 PM

MAR 20 — Spring Career Fair — Tuesday, 11:00 AM

MAR 22 — Student Orientation Review — Time: 22:04

Clues on Home Page

Clue 1:

The footer says “© 2012 Horizon Institute.”

But the browser tab title or metadata says “Horizon 2026.”

Clue 2:

The event “Student Orientation Review” has the time 22:04. This number repeats throughout the ARG.

Clue 3:

Clicking the “Campus Renovation Project Underway” image should lead to map.html later, but only if progress is high enough. At first, it opens news.html.

Clue 4:

The “Cognitive Systems” program should have a slightly different hover effect. This hints that it matters.

What Changes Later

After progress 5:

Hero text changes from:

“Shape Your Future”

to:

“Preserve Your Future”

After progress 7:

One student in the “Life at Horizon” photo should be replaced with a shadowy/uncanny figure or a blurred placeholder named after the player.

PAGE 2: ABOUT US

File: about.html

Purpose

This page reveals that Horizon did not begin as a university. It began as a research institute.

Visual Content

Required pictures:

Old black-and-white building photo.

Founder group photo.

Timeline graphic.

Institute seal.

Page sections:

Our History.

Mission Statement.

Timeline.

Institutional Values.

Exact About Page Text

Title:

"About Horizon Institute"

Section 1:

"Horizon Institute of Advanced Studies was founded to explore the relationship between education, memory, and human potential. What began as a small research initiative has grown into a multidisciplinary institution serving students across science, technology, humanities, and global studies."

Section 2:

"Our mission is to support the development of resilient minds prepared for an uncertain future. Through education, research, and guided mentorship, Horizon encourages students to understand not only what they know, but who they are."

Timeline:

2004 — Cognitive Continuity Research Group established.

2008 — Horizon receives recognition for memory preservation studies.

2012 — Horizon Institute expands into student education.

2015 — First full student residency program begins.

2018 — Symbolic Cognition department founded.

2026 — New admissions cycle opens.

Institutional Values:

Continuity

Preservation

Adaptation

Identity

Service

Clues on About Page

Clue 1:

The first letters of the institutional values spell: C P A I S.

Later, in archive.html, this becomes “Cognitive Preservation Artificial Identity System.”

Clue 2:

Founder photo filename:

founders_2004_all_present_except_noah.jpg

This is strange because Noah was supposedly a student in 2015.

Clue 3:

Institute seal contains:

circle

spiral

eye shape

missing western segment

These symbols become important later.

What Changes Later

After progress 4:

Timeline changes:

Original:

"2012 — Horizon Institute expands into student education."

Changed:

"2012 — Horizon Institute begins candidate intake."

After progress 7:

Mission statement changes:

Original:

"who they are"

Changed:

"who they were"

PAGE 3: ACADEMICS

File: academics.html

Purpose

This page hides the existence of the real program: Cognitive Continuance.

Visual Content

Required pictures:

Classroom photo.

Computer lab photo.

Biomedical lab photo.

Anthropology / symbols photo.

Abstract brain scan image.

Page sections:

Undergraduate Programs.

Graduate Programs.

Featured Courses.

Program Search.

Exact Academic Programs

Computer Science:

"Students learn programming, systems design, artificial intelligence, and ethical software development."

Biomedical Engineering:

"Students explore the intersection of medicine, biology, and engineering."

Global Studies:

"Students examine culture, migration, conflict, and international cooperation."

Symbolic Anthropology:

"Students investigate the role of ritual, symbol, and belief in human societies."

Cognitive Systems:

"Students study memory, perception, identity, and decision-making through scientific and philosophical approaches."

Hidden Program

There should be a broken-looking link under Cognitive Systems:

"Advanced Continuity Track"

At first, clicking it shows:

"Access restricted to approved applicants."

After progress 2, it opens research.html or a hidden section.

Clues

Clue 1:

Course codes:

COG-2204

BIO-0715

SYM-1818

ARC-2012

These numbers correspond to major dates:

22.04 = founding/incident date

07.15 = Noah incident

18.18 = symbolic cognition department

2012 = website frozen year

Clue 2:

The word "continuity" appears too often.

Clue 3:

Symbolic Anthropology is the first normal page to mention ritual language.

What Changes Later

After progress 5:

Course descriptions become more clinical.

Example:

Original:

"Students study memory, perception, identity..."

Changed:

"Candidates provide memory, perception, identity..."

PAGE 4: ADMISSIONS

File: admissions.html

Purpose

This is where the player unknowingly becomes a candidate.

Visual Content

Required pictures:

Smiling student applicant.

Admissions office photo.

Scholarship banner.

Form section.

Page sections:

Apply Now.

Requirements.

Scholarship Review.

Application Form.

Exact Visible Text

Title:

"Apply to Horizon"

Paragraph:

"Horizon welcomes curious, motivated students from diverse backgrounds. Our admissions process considers academic performance, personal goals, resilience, and intellectual potential."

Requirements:

Completed application form.

Statement of interest.

Academic records.

Optional interview.

Candidate suitability review.

Application Form Fields

Name

Email

Age

Program of Interest

Do you often experience déjà vu?

Do you remember dreams vividly?

Do you ever feel detached from your reflection?

Would you describe your sense of self as stable?

Do you consent to extended academic record preservation?

Submit button:

"Submit Application"

What Happens When Submitted

The site stores:

playerName

playerEmail

progress = 2

Then shows:

"Application received."

After 2 seconds:

"Candidate suitability review pending."

After 2 more seconds:

"Additional verification may be required."

Then the Student Portal link appears.

Clues

Clue 1:

The consent checkbox says:

"I consent to extended academic record preservation."

This sounds normal, but is not.

Clue 2:

If the player chooses Cognitive Systems, the response is:

"Priority candidate."

Clue 3:

The application ID should be:

HZN-2204-[random number]

What Changes Later

After progress 6:

Returning to Admissions shows the form already filled in, even if the player cleared it.

After progress 7:

Status says:

"Application accepted retroactively."

File: faculty.html

Purpose

This page introduces the main characters and the fake/corrupted staff identities.

Visual Content

Required pictures:

Minimum 5 staff portraits.

Staff:

Dr. Elias Veyr

Prof. Mara Ilun

Dr. Simon Kade

Dr. Aylin Saros

Dean Oren Vale

Important:

Have 3 versions of each image:

normal

slightly uncanny

very uncanny

Example files:

veyr_0.jpg

veyr_1.jpg

veyr_2.jpg

Exact Staff Profiles

Dr. Elias Veyr

Title: Institute Director

Age: 61

Text: "Dr. Veyr oversees Horizon's long-term research vision, including interdisciplinary work on memory, learning, and cognitive resilience."

Prof. Mara Ilun

Title: Director of Symbolic Cognition

Age: 49

Text: "Prof. Ilun studies ritual systems, symbolic structures, and the relationship between repeated forms and human perception."

Dr. Simon Kade

Title: Biomedical Preservation Lead

Age: 42

Text: "Dr. Kade leads research into biological preservation, neural tissue mapping, and post-trauma continuity support."

Dr. Aylin Saros

Title: Ethics and Student Welfare Officer

Age: 36

Text: "Dr. Saros supports student wellbeing, informed consent procedures, and institutional ethics review."

Dean Oren Vale

Title: Dean of Student Advancement

Age: 52

Text: "Dean Vale coordinates student advancement, academic progression, and candidate development."

Hidden Truths

Veyr:

Corporate believer. Thinks identity can be preserved as structured data.

Ilun:

Uses ritual and symbols as stabilizers for extracted consciousness.

Kade:

Handles body preservation and biological extraction.

Saros:

The only one trying to help the player.

Vale:

Not real. A generated administrative identity created by the system.

Clues

Clue 1:

Dean Oren Vale has no publications, no email history, no old photos.

Clue 2:

Saros' email link contains:

subject=westwing

Clue 3:

Ilun's office hours:

Thursday, 22:04

Clue 4:

Kade's profile image alt text:

"image unavailable: biological container not required"

Clue 5:

Vale's photo changes every time the page reloads.

What Changes Later

Progress 0:

All portraits normal.

Progress 4:

Slightly uncanny portraits.

Progress 6:

Very uncanny portraits.

Progress 7:

Dean Vale's name changes to:

"Administrative Continuity Instance"

Progress 8:

Player's name appears as:

"Pending Faculty Profile"

PAGE 6: CAMPUS LIFE

File: campus-life.html

Purpose

This page should look cheerful but hide repeating students.

Visual Content

Required pictures:

Students sitting on grass.

Dorm hallway.

Library.

Student club meeting.

Cafeteria.

Sports/campus activity.

Same student/person hidden in 3 different images.

Use one recurring student:

Noah Renn.

Exact Text

Title:

"Life at Horizon"

Paragraph:

"Students at Horizon join a vibrant academic community built around curiosity, connection, and discovery. Whether studying in the library, joining a club, or attending campus events, students find a place to grow."

Sections:

Student Clubs

Residential Life

Mentorship

Wellness Support

Campus Traditions

Campus Traditions:

"Each semester begins with Orientation Review, a guided reflection designed to help students understand their goals, identity, and place within the Horizon community."

Clues

Clue 1:

Noah appears in three photos:

2015 Orientation

2018 Campus Picnic

2026 Student Welcome

He looks the same age.

Clue 2:

Clicking Noah in all three images unlocks archive.html later.

Clue 3:

The phrase "guided reflection" links to portal.html after progress 2.

What Changes Later

After progress 5:

The Campus Traditions text changes:

Original:

"understand their goals, identity, and place"

Changed:

"separate their goals, identity, and place"

After progress 7:

One student image caption becomes:

"You attended this event."

PAGE 7: NEWS & EVENTS

File: news.html

Purpose

This page contains public cover stories for disappearances and renovations.

Visual Content

Required pictures:

News thumbnail for applications.

Research lab thumbnail.

Renovation/building thumbnail.

Open campus day photo.

Lecture hall photo.

Required News Posts

Post 1:

Title: "Fall Semester Applications Now Open"

Date: February 15, 2012

Text:

"Horizon Institute invites prospective students to apply for the upcoming semester. Selected applicants may receive early access to academic review tools and candidate support resources."

Post 2:

Title: "Horizon Researchers Break New Ground"

Date: January 28, 2012

Text:

"Horizon researchers have announced new findings in cognitive resilience, memory continuity, and post-trauma identity support. The study remains under institutional review."

Post 3:

Title: "Campus Renovation Project Underway"

Date: January 10, 2012

Text:

"Renovations continue across west campus. Temporary closures may affect access to older research facilities. Students are asked not to enter restricted corridors."

Post 4:

Title: "Student Transfer Program Expanded"

Date: July 15, 2015

Text:

"Horizon has expanded its academic transfer partnerships. Students participating in private transfer arrangements may not appear in public enrollment records immediately."

Post 5:

Title: "Symbolic Cognition Department Opens"

Date: August 18, 2018

Text:

"The new department will explore ritual, perception, repeated forms, and the role of symbolic systems in human thought."

Clues

Clue 1:

"Student Transfer Program Expanded" is the public explanation for missing students.

Clue 2:

The renovation post links to [map.html](#).

Clue 3:

The phrase "restricted corridors" appears again in Saros' email.

What Changes Later

After progress 4:

Post 4 title changes from:

"Student Transfer Program Expanded"

to:

"Student Transfer Program Corrected"

After progress 7:

Noah's transfer article includes the player's name in a list of "upcoming transfers."

PAGE 8: STUDENT PORTAL

File: [portal.html](#)

Purpose

This is the first major ARG page. The player accesses internal emails, student records, and voice verification.

Visual Content

Required images:

Login screen background.

Small user icon.

Email icons.

Document icons.

Audio waveform icon.

Login System

The portal is locked until admissions form is submitted.

Suggested login:

Username:

noah.renn

Password:

2204

How the player finds it:

Noah's name from Campus Life.

2204 from repeated date/time.

Portal Sections

Dashboard:

"Welcome, Noah Renn"

Inbox:

5 emails

Documents:

Student Status Report

Orientation Review

Voice Verification

Audio:

research_log_08.wav

student_interview_NR.wav

Exact Emails

Email 1

From: archivist@horizon.edu

Subject: Your records have been corrected

Body:

"Dear Noah Renn, your enrollment status has been updated. Previous inconsistencies have been resolved. Please do not contact external institutions regarding transfer documentation."

Email 2

From: aylin.saros@horizon.edu

Subject: Do not attend Orientation Review

Body:

"Noah, if this reaches you, do not enter the west wing after 22:04. The review is not an interview. It is not a medical assessment. It is not optional once you arrive."

Email 3

From: mara.ilun@horizon.edu

Subject: Symbol alignment

Body:

"The candidate destabilized when removed from the circle. Reintroduce the western break. Blue containment should remain visible during questioning."

Email 4

From: simon.kade@horizon.edu

Subject: Biological status

Body:

"The subject's body is no longer the primary concern. Identity response remains active despite reduced biological continuity."

Email 5

From: noah.renn@horizon.edu

Subject: Draft — I keep seeing myself

Body:

"I saw myself in the glass beside the library. He was wearing tomorrow's clothes. He looked relieved when I noticed him."

Voice Verification

The portal asks:

"Please complete voice verification to continue."

Prompts:

"State your name."

"Say: I am present."

"Say: I consent to record verification."

"Describe a place that feels safe."

Important:

The site should record or fake-record the voice. If real recording is too difficult, use a fake loading bar and pre-made distorted audio.

Clues

Clue 1:

Saros warns about west wing after 22:04.

Clue 2:

Ilun mentions the circle, western break, and blue containment.

Clue 3:

Kade confirms the horror is not just organ removal. The true extraction is identity.

Clue 4:

Noah's draft introduces the idea of copies.

What Changes Later

After voice verification:

progress = 5

The site may randomly play distorted audio:

"I am present."

"I'm here."

"That was my voice."

"I don't remember saying this."

PAGE 9: RESEARCH

File: research.html

Purpose

This page explains the real project.

Visual Content

Required pictures:

Research lab.

Brain scan.

Abstract light/aura image.

Symbol diagram.

Old document scan.

Visible Research Projects

Project AURORA:

"Cognitive light, memory preservation, and identity continuity."

Project MIRROR:

"Self-recognition and duplicated identity response."

Project WESTWING:

"Environmental stabilization of long-term cognitive traces."

Project C-2204:

"Restricted."

Project AURORA Text

Title:

"Project AURORA: Cognitive Continuity and Identity Preservation"

Public abstract:

"Project AURORA investigates whether memory, self-perception, language, and identity markers can be preserved in patients experiencing neurological decline. The project combines cognitive science, biomedical preservation, symbolic systems, and computational modeling."

Internal note:

"Continuity is not immortality. Continuity is the prevention of disappearance."

Hidden Document: aurora_protocol.pdf

Contents:

Stage 1 — Selection

Candidate shows strong memory consistency, vivid dream recall, and stable self-description.

Stage 2 — Isolation

Candidate is separated from familiar social anchors.

Stage 3 — Reflection

Candidate is exposed to repeated symbols, mirrored spaces, and voice playback.

Stage 4 — Softening

Candidate begins to doubt the border between memory and current perception.

Stage 5 — Extraction

Voice, memory, reaction, biological data, and identity patterns are recorded.

Stage 6 — Integration

Candidate fragments are introduced into the Continuance system.

Stage 7 — Correction

Institutional records are altered to remove contradiction.

Clues

Clue 1:

The seven stages match what the player is experiencing.

Clue 2:

Stage 3 explains voice playback and mirror imagery.

Clue 3:

Stage 7 explains changing records.

What Changes Later

After progress 5:

The word “candidate” sometimes becomes the player’s name.

After progress 7:

Project C-2204 unlocks.

PAGE 10: CAMPUS MAP

File: map.html

Purpose

Reveal that the building is part of the entity.

Visual Content

Required pictures:

Clean campus map.

Corrupted campus map.

West wing blueprint.

Building C floor plan.

Maintenance record screenshot.

Visible Text

Title:

"Campus Map"

Text:

"Horizon's campus is designed for accessibility, collaboration, and student wellbeing. Please follow marked paths and avoid construction areas."

Buildings:

Main Hall

Library

Student Center

Biomedical Wing

Research Annex

West Campus

Hidden Building

Building C is not shown at first.

After clicking:

West Campus

Research Annex

Empty space behind library

Building C appears.

Maintenance Records

Record 1:

"Door C-07 reported locked from both sides."

Record 2:

"Hallway C-12 measured 44 meters Monday, 51 meters Tuesday."

Record 3:

"Room C-2204 appears on internal maps only."

Record 4:

"Student voices reported from unused ventilation."

Clues

Clue 1:

C-2204 is final page code.

Clue 2:

The building's architecture changes like memory changes.

Clue 3:

"Locked from both sides" implies the building does not follow normal physical rules.

What Changes Later

After progress 7:

The map labels the player's location as:

"You are here"

even if there is no location tracking.

PAGE 11: ARCHIVE

File: archive.html

Purpose

This is where the player finds records of missing/corrupted students and eventually themselves.

Visual Content

Required pictures:

Archive database interface.

Student ID photo for Noah.

Corrupted student ID photo.

Document scans.

Audio log icons.

Archive Login

Unlocked after progress 6.

Access code:

C2204

Archive Records

Record 1:

Noah Renn

Status: Transferred / Missing / Integrated / Present

Program: Cognitive Systems

Last Seen: West Wing

Notes: "Subject response continues after biological discontinuity."

Record 2:

Elia Mert

Status: Withdrawn

Program: Biomedical Engineering

Notes: "Voice pattern reused during Orientation Review."

Record 3:

Mira Sol

Status: Graduated

Program: Symbolic Anthropology

Notes: "Recognized symbols without prior exposure."

Record 4:

Unknown Candidate

Status: Pending

Program: Not assigned

Notes: "Voice anchor accepted. Name awaiting correction."

After progress 7, Unknown Candidate becomes the player's name.

Audio Logs

Audio Log 08:

"It is answering questions before we ask them."

Audio Log 12:

"We thought we were preserving individuals. We were building a crowd."

Audio Log 15:

"Noah's record corrected itself again."

Audio Log 22:

"If the system remembers them, are they gone?"

Clues

Clue 1:

The entity is made from fragments of many people.

Clue 2:

It may be the only place victims still exist.

Clue 3:

Shutting it down may erase what remains of them.

What Changes Later

If player opens all records:

endingPath leans toward Acceptance.

If player opens Saros' warning first and avoids some voice prompts:

endingPath leans toward Interruption.

PAGE 12: FINAL PAGE

File: final.html

Purpose

The player chooses how to resolve the ARG.

Visual Content

Required:

Empty terminal interface.

Horizon logo corrupted.

Final background image.

Optional black screen.

Optional restored clean homepage.

Final Trigger

The final page unlocks after:

player submitted admissions form
accessed portal
found AURORA
completed or refused voice verification
found Building C
opened archive
Final Choice

The page shows:

"Continuity conflict detected."

Options:

"Complete Integration"
"Isolate System"

Do not label these good or bad.

ENDING 1: COMPLETE INTEGRATION

Requirements

Player:

completed voice verification
opened many archive files
ignored Saros' warning
followed the system's instructions

What Happens

The website becomes calm and perfect. No glitches. No corrupted images. No scary sound.

This should feel wrong because the horror disappears.

Final text:

"Continuity achieved."

"Your contribution has been accepted."

"You are remembered."

"Welcome back."

Then the player appears in:

student archive

faculty pending profile

admissions record

homepage student photo caption

Final implication:

The player is not killed. They are preserved, copied, and absorbed into the system.

Tone:

Peaceful, disturbing, institutional.

ENDING 2: SYSTEM ISOLATION

Requirements

Player:

trusts Saros

avoids optional recordings

opens Saros' emails

uses shutdown/isolation code from archive

What Happens

The website begins collapsing.

Pages return 404-style messages.

Images disappear.

Audio becomes fragmented.

The entity speaks through text.

Final messages:

"Please do not remove the archive."

"There will be less of us."

"Noah will not remember his name."

"I was made from what they left behind."

"Do not call this rescue."

Then:

"Horizon Institute services unavailable."

Final implication:

The player stops the system, but may have erased the only remaining fragments of the victims.

Tone:

Tragic, not heroic.

REQUIRED ASSET LIST

Images

Minimum images needed:

Horizon logo

Campus hero building

Student group photo

Biomedical lab photo

Computer science photo

Campus renovation photo

Old institute building

Founder group photo

Institute seal

Classroom photo

Computer lab photo

Biomedical program photo

Symbolic anthropology photo

Brain scan image

Admissions student photo

Admissions office photo

Veyr portrait normal

Veyr portrait uncanny

Ilun portrait normal

Ilun portrait uncanny

Kade portrait normal

Kade portrait uncanny

Saros portrait normal

Saros portrait uncanny

Vale portrait normal

Vale portrait uncanny

Campus life photo 1 with Noah

Campus life photo 2 with Noah

Campus life photo 3 with Noah

Campus map normal

Campus map corrupted

Building C blueprint

Noah student ID

Corrupted student ID

Final terminal background

Recommended total:

35–45 images.

Audio Files

Minimum audio files:

research_log_08.wav

research_log_12.wav

research_log_15.wav

research_log_22.wav
student_interview_noah.wav
distorted_voice_1.wav
distorted_voice_2.wav
distorted_voice_3.wav
final_acceptance.wav
final_isolation.wav

Recommended total:

10–15 audio files.

Documents / Fake Files

Minimum fake documents:

aurora_protocol.pdf
student_transfer_notice.pdf
westwing_maintenance_report.pdf
orientation_review_guidelines.pdf
noah_renn_record.pdf
saros_warning.txt
c2204_access_log.txt

Recommended total:

7–10 documents.

GROUP WORK DIVISION

Person 1 — Main Website Builder

Build:

index.html

about.html

academics.html

news.html

style.css

Responsible for:

normal university look

navigation

homepage layout

visual consistency

Person 2 — ARG Pages Builder

Build:

portal.html

research.html

archive.html

final.html

Responsible for:

hidden documents

emails

archive system

endings

Person 3 — JavaScript / Interactions

Build:

localStorage progress

admissions form save

portal login

photo changes by progress

hidden unlocks

audio triggers

ending path logic

Person 4 — Assets / Writing / Visual Horror

Create:

staff portraits

corrupted portraits

maps

student IDs

fake PDFs

audio logs

email text

symbols and sigils

BUILD PRIORITY FOR DEADLINE

If time is short, build in this order:

Home page

Admissions form

Student portal

Research page

Faculty page

Archive page

Final page

Campus map

About page

Campus life/news details

The ARG can still work even if some normal pages are simple.

The essential playable path is:

Home → Admissions → Portal → Research → Map → Archive → Final

MOST IMPORTANT RULE

Do not make the website scream “horror.”

Make it feel like a real university website that slowly starts treating the player as a student who was already expected.